THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention o n the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environ ment Protection Committee conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevent ion and control of marine pollution from ships, RECALLING ALSO that the International Co nference on Ballast Water Management for Ships held in February 2004 adopted the Interna tional Convention for the Control and Management of Ships' Ballast Water and Sediments, 2004 (the Convention) together with four Conference resolutions, NOTING that regulation A -2 of the Convention requires that discharge of ballast water shall only be conducted through ballast water management in accordance with the provisions of the Annex to the C onvention, - resolutions, NOTING that regulation A -2 of the Convention requires that di scharge of ballast water shall only be conducted through ballast water management in acc ordance with the provisions of the Annex to the Convention, NOTING ALSO that regulation B-4 of the Annex to the Convention addresses the conditions under which ballast water ex change should be conducted, taking into account Guidelines developed by the Organization , NOTING FURTHER that, at its fifty-third session, it adopted, by resolution MEPC.124(53), the Guidelines for ballast water exchange (G6) and resolved to keep them under review , NOTING that, having considered draft revised Guidelines (G6), at its seventy-first ses sion, it adopted, by resolution MEPC.288(71), the 2017 Guidelines for ballast water exch ange (G6), HAVING CONSIDERED, at its eightieth session, proposed amendments to the